Japan Portfolio Brief — Tuesday, November 3, 2026

Covers Mon Nov 2 evening through Tue Nov 3. **Tokyo is closed today (Culture Day)**; Korea is open. **Data-quality warning (continuing):** WebSearch returned mostly snippets, and fetches of kabutan, kabuyoho, TDnet, DART, MOF, BoJ, company IR and several news sites failed. Almost nothing dated Nov 2–3 surfaced, so most of this brief restates verified-as-far-as-possible context from Oct 27–Nov 2. "QUIET" means "nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are mostly aggregator-sourced (kabuyoho, Matsui, TradingView) and flagged where sources conflict. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call.

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1. Top of the stack

1. JGB No. 466 (JP1024661QB1) matured Sunday Nov 1 — redemption/settlement still unverified. Redemption should have settled Mon Nov 2; no MOF or custodian source was found. Tokyo is closed today, so the reinvestment decision cannot execute until Wed Nov 4. Reference levels: 10y about 2.83% and 30y about 3.90% on MOF closes of Oct 27, per one undated source (Admiral Markets; not opened). The same source puts the 30y record at 4.235% on Oct 5 and the 10y near 3.1% in early October, so the long end has rallied hard in three weeks (verify against the MOF table).

2. Korean tape conflict for Nov 2 — verify the KOSPI close. Yesterday's brief had KOSPI +2.24% to 5,859.08 on the chip rebound (multiple sources). A search summary today claims Nov 2 closed **-3.59% at 5,648.79** with no source link captured. The two cannot both be right; yesterday's figure had several corroborating outlets, so treat the -3.59% as probably mislabelled (it resembles the Oct 30 drop of about -3.5%). The Nov 3 close was not found. MATTERS: check Naver Finance or KRX.

3. Apple reported Nov 2 (US): beat, but Greater China missed and memory cost is the worry. Revenue about $114.5bn, EPS about $2.10 vs about $2.00 expected, gross margin 47.9%, Q1 revenue growth guided 7–10%; Greater China $17.54bn vs $18.75bn expected (Yahoo Finance live, FXStreet; snippets only). Read-through to Sony, Canon, Seiko Epson, Omron and the memory chain (Kioxia, SK hynix). A reported -4.59% move is unclear in timing.

4. SoftBank Group H1 results confirmed for Tue Nov 10 (tanshin 15:30, briefing 16:30) (SoftBank; snippet). It arranged a two-year loan of about $11.87bn from about 20 banks in September (Business Standard). Earnings will be dominated by OpenAI valuation gains and leverage commentary. No new news Nov 2–3.

5. Keyence and JR Central results finally located (secondary sources). Keyence H1 (Oct 29): sales about ¥735.4bn, operating profit about ¥408.3bn (about +35% and +50% y/y, margin about 55.5%) per a third-party aggregator, unverified (edinetdb; not opened). JR Central (Oct 28): FY3/27 net profit forecast raised ¥40bn to ¥487.0bn (-12% y/y) on Shinkansen strength; H1 net ¥288.4bn (-3%) (Nikkei; headline/summary only). Resolves a three-run open item.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ:** held at 1.25% (8–1, Takata dissent for 1.5%) on Oct 30 per last run's sources (ActionForex). Today's macro search could not independently confirm the level (one March 2026 snippet showed 0.75%, consistent with hikes since) and found no new Ueda remarks or December odds; last run's 68% figure remains low-grade.
- **JGBs:** see Section 1. 2y/5y not found today. Tokyo closed, no trading.
- **Yen:** no Nov 2–3 level found; last run about 157.7–157.9. Prior interventions: around Apr 30–May 1 above 160 (FX Leaders) and a US-Japan coordinated move around Aug when USD/JPY neared 164 (Star Advertiser). The 158 zone remains sensitive.
- **Bank of Korea:** base rate 3.00%, held Oct 22 (7–0) after July and August hikes. On Nov 3 the BoK said inflation would stay in the upper-2% range (Seoul Economic Daily). October CPI was reported at 2.8% y/y (release-date conflict with the Nov 4

estimate in last run). Next meeting Nov 26 per Trading Economics (forecast 3.25%); FXStreet shows Nov 25 with a 3.0% consensus — conflict. USD/KRW not found.

- **Korea structure:** Commercial Act amendment requires cancelling newly bought treasury shares within 1 year and existing holdings within 18 months (Asiae); relevant to SK Inc, Taekwang, SK Discovery, Samyang Tongsang. No new MSCI news.

Megacaps / tech (Japan)

- **Kioxia / Advantest (read-through):** Kioxia H1 (Oct 30): revenue about ¥4.25tn, operating profit about ¥3.27tn, first interim dividend — the 77% margin looks extreme, verify (SBBIT; single source). Advantest raised guidance again Oct 29, net profit +97% (Newswitch; snippet). Strong fundamentals despite last week's price rout.
- **SoftBank Group (9984):** see Section 1. MATTERS into Nov 10.
- **Canon (7751):** 9M sales ¥3.433tn (+4.0%), operating profit ¥327.7bn (+8.4%), net ¥246.4bn (+12.2%); full-year pretax forecast flat at ¥483bn, 1.1% below consensus; memory and raw-material costs a headwind (Monex). NOISE now.
- **Keyence (6861):** see Section 1; stock reaction not found.
- **Sony (6758):** H1 date "mid-Nov" per kabuyoho; Nov 10–12 plausible (last year Nov 11, Gamebiz). QUIET. **Seiko Epson, Omron, Appier, SHIFT, Oro, Optex, MegaChips, RS Technologies, Sanken:** nothing found. QUIET/unverified; beta to Apple/memory read-through.

Banks / financials

- **SBI Holdings (8473):** kabuyoho lists H1 results as Nov 2; numbers not found. Check TDnet.
- **SMTG (8309):** H1 Nov 12 per kabuyoho. **MUFG:** no 2026 date; last year Nov 14, expect about Nov 12–14 (unverified).
- **Kita-Nippon (8551):** only a May dividend-raise disclosure (JPX); no tie-up news. **8524:** see Section 4 flag.
- **Resona, Kyoto FG, Shimizu Bank, Fidea, Japan Post, Mitsui Fudosan, Yakult, Shochiku, Universal Entertainment, TOC:** nothing found. QUIET/unverified; most H1 reports Nov 4–14.

Industrials / autos / small-mid caps

- **JR Central (9022):** see Section 1. No further catalyst until late January.
- **Daikin (6367):** H1 Nov 5 per kabuyoho; Q1 ordinary profit ¥120.8bn (29.2% of ¥414bn FY forecast).
- **Subaru (7270):** Nov 6 per BSR vs Nov 10 per kabuyoho — conflict. Q1 operating profit -44%.
- **Suzuki (7269):** Q1 record, but FY operating-profit forecast cut ¥30bn to ¥540bn on Middle East raw-material costs (Yahoo Carview); H1 date unconfirmed (early Nov to Nov 10). **Honda:** "mid-Nov," unconfirmed.
- **Kubota (6326):** December FY; H1 was Aug 4 (pretax forecast raised to ¥417bn, Monex); Q3 early Nov, date unconfirmed. Correction to last run's "Nov 9 H1."
- **Sumitomo Metal Mining:** Q2 Nov 10 per Matsui. **Mitsubishi Materials:** mid-Nov (last year Nov 11).
- **Nakayama Steel (5408):** H1 Nov 5 (kabuyoho) vs Nov 10 (TradingView) — conflict; FY ordinary profit forecast ¥2.0bn (-58%). **Tigers Polymer:** H1 Nov 11 16:00. **Valqua:** early Nov, unconfirmed. **Katakura:** Q3 mid-Nov. **Hi-Lex:** Oct FY-end; Q3 sales ¥320.6bn (+40.8%), operating profit ¥3.9bn; full year about Dec 12.
- **Keisei, JAPEX, Tokyotokeiba, Shibaura Machine, KH Neochem, Ebara Jitsugyo, Fudo Tetra, Obara:** nothing found, no dates found. QUIET/unverified.

Korea names

- **LG Chem pref / LG Corp:** Oct 28 board approved selling about ₩2.5tn of LG Energy Solution shares (6.54M shares, 2.79%, via a two-year PRS swap), selling from Nov 27, stake 79.4% to 76.59%; also a ₩300bn buyback with cancellation (Economist, SBS Biz; search summaries). Corrects last run's framing. LGES Q3 preliminary operating profit ₩756bn incl. US 45X credit (Bizwatch). Relevant to LG Corp NAV. LG Chem Q3 not found.

- **Samsung C&T (028260):** Q3 (Oct 28) construction operating profit ₩277bn (+149.5%) (SBS Biz); consolidated ₩1.14tn from one source — verify on DART.
- **Taekwang (003240):** MATTERS (live), nothing new. Trustone's Sep 3 open letter set a 30-day deadline (about Oct 3) with threatened EGM request and criminal complaint; outcome unknown (Bizwatch). Watch DART for an EGM request.
- **SK Inc (034730):** March decision to cancel about 14.69M treasury shares (about 20%) by Jan 2027 (Herald). SK hynix Q3 operating profit ₩83.3tn.
- **NAVER:** Q3 Nov 11, 16:00 (KnowingAsset; moderate confidence).
- **LG Electronics pref:** Q3 operating profit ₩781.8bn (+13.5%), below consensus, mentioned extra ₩100bn shareholder return next year (SBS Biz).
- **Amorepacific Group, Hyosung (Q3 results reported Oct 29 per last run), LS Corp, SK Discovery, F&F, ILJIN, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, Misto, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss:** nothing new found; Q3 statutory deadline Nov 14. QUIET/unverified.

3. Probably noise

- **Canon Q3 (Oct 27):** priced; forecast 1.1% below consensus only.
- **KOSPI "-3.59% to 5,648.79" for Nov 2:** unsourced; conflicts with multi-source +2.24%. Ignore until verified.
- **Subaru/Nakayama date conflicts:** immaterial until the dates settle.
- **Old 2025 BoJ/BoK articles in search results (e.g., CNBC 2025 BoK 2.5%):** stale, ignore.
- **Katakura net-profit forecast ¥7.45bn vs ¥7.25bn:** aggregator discrepancy.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB No. 466 (0.50%, JP1024661QB1) — matured Sun Nov 1. Maturity confirmed earlier on the MOF auction page; ISIN→No. 466 mapping remains inferred; settlement unverified (no MOF/custodian page found today). **Decisions:** (1) confirm with the custodian that proceeds settled and the mapping; (2) reinvest or hold cash — Tokyo closed today, next window Wed Nov 4; reference 10y about 2.8%, long end volatile, December BoJ hike odds roughly two-thirds (low-grade). **`watchlist-japan.md` needs updating once redemption is confirmed;** line retained with a flag.

*Calendar (= aggregator/inferred/conflicting):**

- Nov 3: Tokyo closed; Korea open
- Nov 4: Korea CPI* (release date conflict)
- Nov 5: Daikin*; Nakayama Steel*; LG Chem Q3*
- Nov 5–10: Subaru* (Nov 6 vs 10)
- Nov 6: US October payrolls (not re-verified)
- Nov 10: **SoftBank Group (15:30)**; Sumitomo Metal Mining; Suzuki/Honda*
- Nov 11: **NAVER (16:00)**; Tigers Polymer (16:00)
- Nov 12: SMTG; Sony*, MUFG* (Nov 12–14)
- Nov 13: 8524 Q2 (14:00, per kabuyoho)
- Mid-Nov: Honda*, Mitsubishi Materials*, Katakura*, Kubota Q3*, Resona*, Japan Post*, Kyoto FG*, Fidea*; Korea small caps by Nov 14
- Nov 26 (or 25): Bank of Korea
- Nov 27: LG Chem LGES share sale begins

Undated-but-live: SoftBank/OpenAI leverage; AI-capex and memory-cost sentiment; Taekwang–Trustone EGM; Samsung ₩75tn return decision; December BoJ hike; BoK hike; yen near 158; Suzuki Q2 risk.

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for the owner.** 8524 = 北洋銀行 (The North Pacific Bank, Sapporo, Hokkaido; one agent's "Hokuyo Bank" gloss is the same bank's Japanese name); 8551 = The Kita-Nippon Bank (Iwate). Coverage follows 8551. Please confirm which is held.
2. **JGB JP1024661QB1:** matured Nov 1; mapping inferred; settlement unverified.
3. **JR Central and Keyence results now located** (secondary sources); flags cleared in the brief, figures unverified.
4. No other identity changes confirmed.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** custodian confirmation of Nov 2 settlement; reinvestment plan vs BoJ December odds.
- **KOSPI Nov 2 and Nov 3 closes:** resolve the +2.24% vs -3.59% conflict; USD/KRW level.
- **SoftBank (9984):** Nov 2 close, OpenAI exposure and LTV ahead of Nov 10.
- **Keyence (6861):** verify H1 figures against the tanshin and the stock reaction.
- **LG Chem / LG Corp:** DART confirmation of the LGES PRS sale terms; LG Chem Q3 date.
- **SBI Holdings:** locate Nov 2 H1 results.
- **Taekwang (003240):** outcome of Trustone's Oct 3 deadline; any EGM filing.
- **Apple read-through:** price reactions in Sony, Canon, Seiko Epson, SK hynix.
- **Unsearched/unresolved names:** about 25 Japan and Korea small and mid caps need a per-ticker pass; allowing kabutan.jp, release.tdnet.info, dart.fss.or.kr, boj.or.jp, mof.go.jp, tradingeconomics.com and company IR hosts would fix most gaps.